

1. OS & ARCHITECTURE

OS Fundamentals

- Resource Allocator: Manages/allocates resources.
- Control Program: Controls execution & I/O.
- Kernel: The one program always running.
- Monolithic: 1 big program (Unix, Win). Fast, crashy.
- Microkernel: Minimized (IPC/Mem only). Services run as user procs. Secure, stable, slow.

Hypervisors:

- Type 1 (Bare Metal): Replaces OS (Enterprise).
- Type 2 (Host OS): Runs on OS (VirtualBox).

Real-Time Systems (RTOS)

- Must satisfy bounded response time; correctness relies on output and timeliness.
- Focus: Time-critical (schedulers guarantee execution upper-bound/deadline), reliable, sensor/actuator ops.
- Response Time: Time from input to output.

2. INTERRUPTS & POLLING

Polling vs Interrupts

- Polling Cons: CPU busy-waits, wastes energy.
- Interrupt System: OS is interrupt-driven (idles if none).
- Device buffer → CPU cache. Device controller fires int.
- Flow: Request → CPU gets int number → Look up address in Interrupt Vector → Execute ISR.

Interrupt Handling

- OS saves Registers & PC (preserve CPU state).
- OS determines int type; executes specific ISR code.
- OS restores context & resumes tasks.
- Interrupt Response Time (T_D): Latency + Processing.
- RT req: $T_D < \text{Time between interrupts}$.
- High-priority ints increase latency of low-priority ones.

Split Processing: ISR does minimal work (copy data, reset HW) → Queues pointer to defer main work to dedicated task (avoids missing deadlines).

System Calls

Escalates user prog to OS functions (slow/intensive). Flow: User invokes → Lib puts syscall # in Reg → TRAP (switch to Kernel mode) → Handle → Return.

3. PROCESSES & THREADS

Program: Static entity. Process: Executing pgm. Context Switch: Save old state, load new. Pure overhead. Process Model: Simplifies concurrent design.

Process States

- Created: PCB init. Waits for minimal resources.
- Ready: Competes for CPU. (RTOS: must not disrupt timing of active system).
- Running: Actively executing on CPU.
- Blocked: Waiting for I/O or Sync. Not competing.
- Terminated: Done/Error. PCB kept for data retrieval.

Running → Ready Transitions: Pre-emption (Involuntary: scheduler forces out) vs Yield (Voluntary: process asks OS to reschedule).

Process Creation

- fork(): Exact clone. Ret 0 to child, PID to parent. Inherits PC, Code, Data/Stack copy, Open Files.
- exec(): Replaces memory/code with new pgm.
- wait(status): Parent blocks until child exits.

Threads

- Unit of execution inside a process.
- Shared: Heap, Data (Globals), Files, Code.
- Private: Stack, Registers (PC/SP), Thread ID.
- User Threads: Managed by Lib. Fast. OS blind (if 1 blocks on I/O, whole process blocks). No true SMP.
- Kernel Threads: Managed by OS. Slower. HW-aware (True SMP). Schedulable by OS.
- Hybrid: User threads multiplexed on Kernel threads.

Pthreads: pthread_t (TID), pthread_attr (Attrs).

4. CONTEXT & MEMORY

Hardware Context

PC (Program Counter): Address of next instruction. SP (Stack Pointer): Top (1st unused loc) of stack. FP (Frame Pointer): Fixed loc in stack frame to access local vars via displacement. Register Spilling: If GPR exhausted, save to RAM temporarily. Calling Convention & Layout

Standard protocol for Setup/Teardown of stack frames. Stacks typically grow upwards (lowest addr at bottom, highest at top, incrementing SP). Memory: Text (Instrs) → Data (Globals) → Heap (Dynamic) ↑ ↓ Stack (Func invocations).

5. CPU SCHEDULING

- Goal: Decide who runs and for how long.
- Metrics:
 - WCET (C): Worst-Case Execution Time.
 - Deadline (D): Max time allowed from release to completion.
 - WCRT (R): Worst-Case Response Time (actual).
- Nonpreemptive: Task holds CPU till yield/I/O.
- Preemptive: CPU can be taken by OS anytime.
- Interactive Sched: Focus on response/predictability. Uses timer interrupts (1-10ms) & Time Quanta.

RTOS Scheduling Algorithms

- Fixed Priority: Priorities assigned manually, never change.
- RMS (Rate Monotonic): Optimal fixed scheme. Shorter Period = Higher Priority.
- Dynamic Priority:
 - EDF (Earliest Deadline First): Closest deadline gets highest priority.

Schedulability Analysis

- Utilization (U): Sum of (C / Period) for all tasks.
- $U > 1.0$: Failed (Overloaded).
- $U \leq \text{LL-Bound}$: Passed (Guaranteed).
- $LL < U \leq 1.0$: Critical Instance Analysis.
- Critical Instance Analysis: Worst case scenario is all tasks release at $t = 0$.
- Step 1: Calc total WCET = t .
- Step 2: Tasks may release during t . Add new compute recursively.
- Step 3: Repeat until $t > \text{Max Period (fail)}$ or converges (pass).

Note: Can try RMS even if LL bound fails, use Critical Analysis.

Round Robin & Priority

- Round Robin (RR): FIFO + Time Quantum. Fast response. Cons: Fails RTOS timing/fragile, no priority.
- RR w/ Interrupts: Tasks polled, but ISR handles time-critical ints. Cons: Data processing delayed.
- Priority Sched: Highest priority runs. Preemptive vs Non.

1. INTER-PROCESS COMMUNICATION (IPC)

- Shared Memory: Efficient but requires synchronization.
 - POSIX Syscalls: shmget() (create), shmat() (attach), shmdt() (detach), shmctl() (destroy).
 - Master Code:
 - shmid = shmget(IPC_PRIVATE, 40, IPC_CREAT | 0600);
 - shm = (int*) shmat(shmid, NULL, 0);
- Message Passing: OS handles memory; portable, easier sync, but inefficient.
 - Naming: Direct (Send(P2, Msg)) vs. Indirect via Mailbox/Port (Send(MB, Msg)).
 - Synchronization: Blocking (Synchronous) vs. Non-Blocking (Asynchronous).
- Unix Pipes: Circular bounded byte buffer. Implicit sync (writers wait if full, readers if empty). Half/Full-duplex.
 - Syscall: pipe(int fd[]). fd[0] = read end, fd[1] = write end.
 - Code:
 - pipe(fd);
 - if(fork() > 0) {
 - close(fd[0]); write(fd[1], str, len);
 - } else {
 - close(fd[1]); read(fd[0], buf, len);
 - }
 - Redirection: dup(), dup2().
- Unix Signals: Synchronous event notification.
 - Code: if (signal(SIGSEGV, myHandler) == SIG_ERR) { ... }

2. MEMORY ABSTRACTION & ALLOCATION

- Base + Limit Registers: Hardware abstraction. Actual = Base + Adr. Must check Actual < Limit.
- Contiguous Memory Allocation:
 - Fixed-Size Partition: Fast, easy. Causes Internal Fragmentation (wasted space inside partition).
 - Variable-Size Partition: Flexible. Causes External Fragmentation (holes between partitions).
 - Algorithms: First-Fit (first hole large enough), Best-Fit (smallest hole large enough), Worst-Fit (largest hole).
- Buddy System: Efficient splitting/coalescing using powers of $2(2^k)$.
 - Blocks B and C are buddies if their S^{th} bit is a complement and leading bits are identical.
 - Maintains an array of linked lists A[0...K] for free blocks of size 2^J .

3. VIRTUAL MEMORY MANAGEMENT

- Memory Access Time:
 - $T_{access} = (1 - p) \times T_{mem} + p \times T_{page_fault}$ (where p = page fault probability).
- Paging: Splits logical memory into pages, physical memory into frames.
 - Page Fault: Trap to OS when accessing a non-memory resident page.
- Page Table Structures:

- Direct Paging: Single table. Huge memory overhead (e.g., 32-bit addr, 4KiB page = 2MiB table).
- 2-Level Paging: Splits table into a Page Directory + smaller Page Tables. Saves space because empty directory entries mean unallocated page tables.
- Inverted Page Table: One table for all processes, ordered by physical frame. Entry = <PID, Page#>. Huge memory savings, but slow translation (requires search/hashing).
- Page Replacement Algorithms (Triggered when physical memory is full):
 - OPT (Optimal): Replace page not used for the longest future time. Unrealizable benchmark.
 - FIFO: Evict oldest loaded page. Suffers from Belady's Anomaly (more frames = more page faults).
 - LRU (Least Recently Used): Exploits temporal locality.
 - Implementations: Counter (search for smallest time, overflow risk) or Stack (move referenced to top, evict bottom; hard to do in HW).
 - CLOCK (Second-Chance): FIFO with a reference bit. If bit=0, replace. If bit=1, set to 0 (give 2nd chance) and move to next.

- Thrashing & Working Set:
 - Thrashing: Heavy I/O from constant page faults.
 - Working Set Model: $W(t, \Delta)$ = active pages in interval Δ . Allocate enough frames for the working set to prevent thrashing.
 - Local vs Global Replacement: Global allows stealing frames from other processes (can cause cascading thrashing). Local restricts a process to its own frames.

4. SYNCHRONIZATION

- Critical Section (CS) Properties: 1. Mutual Exclusion, 2. Progress - if nothing is in critical section, process is granted access, 3. Bounded Wait - after p_i request entry, exist an upper-bound number of times other processes can enter before p_i , 4. Independence - processes never block each other.
- Deadlock = no progress | livelock = not blocked but no progress because deadlock avoidance | starvation - process is blocked forever
- Hardware Level: TestAndSet Reg, MemLoc. Atomic instruction.
 - Code: while(TestAndSet(Lock) == 1);
- Semaphore: Integer + waiting list. No busy waiting.
 - Wait(S) / P(): If $S \leq 0$, block/sleep. Decrement S.
 - Signal(S) / V(): Increment S. Wake up one sleeping process. Never blocks.
- Producer-Consumer (Blocking Code):
 - Producer:
 - wait(notFull); wait(mutex);
 - add_to_buffer;
 - signal(mutex); signal(notEmpty);
 - Consumer:
 - wait(notEmpty); wait(mutex);
 - remove_from_buffer;
 - signal(mutex); signal(notFull);

- Readers-Writers: Writer needs exclusive access; readers can share.
- Pthreads: pthread_mutex_lock(), pthread_cond_wait(), pthread_cond_broadcast().

5. FILE SYSTEM

- File Data Structure & Access:
 - Fixed Length Records: Easy jump. Offset = Size x (N - 1).
 - Access Methods: Sequential (read in order) vs Random/Direct (read(offset) or seek(offset)).
- Directory Structures:
 - Single-Level vs Tree-Structured (Absolute/Relative paths).
 - DAG (Directed Acyclic Graph): Allows file sharing.
 - Hard Direct: Multiple directory pointers to the same disk file. Pros: Low overhead. Cons: Deletion orphans (if owner deletes, link breaks).
 - Symbolic Link: Special file containing the path. Pros: Simple deletion. Cons: Disk space overhead.
- Disk Organization: MBR → Partitions → [OS Boot Block | Partition Details | Directory Structure | Files Info | File Data].
- File Block Allocation:
 - Contiguous: Directory stores start & length. Pros: Fast, simple. Cons: External fragmentation, file size fixed.
 - Linked List: Block stores data + pointer to next. Directory stores start & end. Pros: No fragmentation. Cons: Slow random access, pointer overhead.
 - FAT (Linked List V2): Moves pointers to a File Allocation Table in RAM. Pros: Fast random access.
 - Indexed: Directory points to an Index Block (array of block addresses). Pros: Fast direct access. Cons: Max file size limited by index block size.
 - Unix Inode (Combined): Uses direct blocks, single indirect, double indirect, and triple indirect pointers for massive files.
- Free Space Management:
 - Bitmap: 1 bit per block (0=occupied, 1=free). Fast manipulations, but takes up RAM.
 - Linked List: Blocks store pointers to next free block. Low

- memory overhead, but slow.
- Disk I/O Scheduling:
 - Time = Seek Time (move head to track) + Rotational Latency (wait for sector) + Transfer Time.
 - Algorithms: FCFS (First Come First Serve), SSF (Shortest Seek First), SCAN (Elevator: Bi-directional innermost ↔ outermost). Focus is on reducing Seek Time.

REAL-TIME SCHEDULABILITY

The iterative equation for task response time t_i is defined as:

$$t_i = \sum_{k=1}^n \text{tasks} (\text{WCET of } k\text{th task}) \left\lceil \frac{t_i - 1}{\text{period}} \right\rceil$$

where $t_0 = \sum \text{WCET}$

Schedulability Regions (Utilization U)

- Not Schedulable: Occurs when $U > 1$.
- Necessary Condition: $U \leq 1$.
- May or may not be schedulable: The region where $n(2^{1/n} - 1) < U \leq 1$.
- Sufficient Condition: $U \leq n(2^{1/n} - 1)$.
- Schedulable: Guaranteed when the utilization is within the sufficient condition range.

FUNCTION CALL CONVENTIONS

On executing function call

- Caller: Pass arguments with registers and/or stack.
- Caller: Save Return PC on stack.
- Transfer control from caller to callee.
- Callee: Save registers used by callee. Save old Frame Pointer (FP) and Stack Pointer (SP).
- Callee: Allocate space for local variables of callee on stack.
- Callee: Adjust SP to point to new stack top.

On returning from function call

- Callee: Restore saved registers, FP, and SP.
- Transfer control from callee to caller using saved PC.
- Caller: Continues execution in caller.

EXCEPTION/INTERRUPT HANDLER ILLUSTRATION

Process Flow

- Exception/Interrupt occurs:
 - Control transfers to a handler routine automatically.
- Return from handler routine:
 - Program execution resumes.
 - May behave as if nothing happened.

Handler Routine Steps

- Save Register/CPU state.
- Perform the handler routine.
- Restore Register/CPU state.
- Return from interrupt.

PROCESS CREATION USING FORK()

```
int main() {
    pid_t pid = fork();
    if (pid == 0) { // Child process
        // ...
    } else if (pid > 0) { // Parent process
        // ...
    }
```

```
int pthread_create(
    pthread_t *tidCreated,
    const pthread_attr_t *threadAttributes,
    void* (*startRoutine)(void*),
    void *argForStartRoutine
);
void pthread_exit( void* exitValue );
int pthread_join( pthread_t threadID, void **status );
```

KEY POINTERS

1. Synchronization & Interrupts

- Disabling Interrupts: Not a good choice for locking. Breaks quantum-based process switching (timer interrupts fail), misses important wakeup signals from ISRs, and can hang the entire system.
- Pipes as Binary Semaphores (Locks):
 - fd[0] in pipe, fd[1] for write used via "Token" concept.
 - 1 byte in read = Lock is Available. 0 bytes = Lock is Held.
 - Acquire: read() blocks until a byte is present, ensuring only one thread gets the token (Atomic).
 - Release: write() returns the byte, unblocking one waiting thread.

2. Process & Memory Mgmt

- Context Switching: Saves the state of a running process. Requires: (1) Flushing the TLB (or using ASIDs to prevent unauthorized memory access), (2) Loading the new page table, (3) Setting the PT base register.
- Preemptive vs. Non-preemptive: Preemptive OSs (Interactive) can forcibly interrupt processes. Non-preemptive (Real-time) cannot.
- Memory Partitions: Fixed-Size: Fast/simple, static, causes Internal Frag. Variable-Size: Flexible, causes External Frag.
- Segmentation: Out-of-bounds access is catchable via Segment Limit. A process's Heap does not create a new segment when it grows; the OS simply increases the limit of the existing heap segment.

3. Virtual Memory & Paging

- Page Faults & Limits: Incorrect memory access in paging is not inherently catchable by boundary limits unless it hits an "Invalid" (Valid Bit = 0) page.
- Multi-level Paging: Split memory so every page table fits exactly into one physical page frame.
- Inverted Page Table: One global table for the OS. One entry per physical frame (Index = Frame). Matches using [PID | p | d].
- Page Replacement Algorithms: OPT (Benchmark), FIFO (Oldest out, Belady's Anomaly), LRU (Least Recently Used), CLOCK (Circular FIFO, skips reference bit = 1).
- Working Set Model & Thrashing: Used to allocate frames and prevent thrashing. Adjust the window (L or Δ) based on page fault frequency (High freq = Δ too small; low freq + low CPU = Δ too large).

4. fork(), exec(), and CoW

- CoW Logic: fork() initially shares physical frames between Parent and Child, marking them Read-Only (W = 0).
- Write Attempt (Trap): If a child modifies a RAM variable, a Memory Violation occurs. The OS catches this, copies the frame to a new physical location, and sets W = 1 so the child has a private copy.
- exec() vs write(): If the child calls exec(), it discards the parent's memory entirely (no CoW needed). Writing to a file descriptor (write()) does not trigger memory CoW unless the memory buffer itself is altered.

5. File Systems & I/O

- File Descriptors (FD): Non-negative integers serving as handles for an OS array (0 = stdin, 1 = stdout, 2 = stderr). Using open() gives an FD, saving the OS from expensive disk searches on every read/write.
- Redirection (>): To redirect standard output, the OS closes fd=1 and points it to the new file's entry.
- Inodes: Store metadata and pointers to disk blocks.
- Triply Indirect Pointers: If a file grows into the triple-indirect range, writing just 1 byte requires 4 disk writes (3 index blocks + 1 data block).
- Free Space: Managed by Bitmaps (fast but takes RAM) or Linked Lists.

KEY EQUATIONS

1. Address Mapping & Offsets

- Base + Limit Mapping: Actual_Physical = Base + Offset (Must check: Offset < Limit)
- Buddy System Mapping: Physical = Start_of_2^k_Block + Offset (Must check: Offset < 2^k)
- File Fixed-Length Records: Offset = Record_Size × (N - 1)

2. Memory Architecture Calculations

- Number of Frames: Physical_Address_Space ÷ Frame_Size
- Number of Pages: Logical_Address_Space ÷ Page_Size
- Total Page Table Entries (PTEs): Number_of_Pages
- Single-Level Page Table Size: Number_of_Pages × PTE_Size
- Entries per Multi-Level Table: Frame_Size ÷ Entry_Size

3. Performance & Access Times

- Effective Access Time (T_access):
T_access = (1 - p) × T_mem + p × T_page_fault
(where p is probability of page fault)
- TLB Miss Time (n-level paging):
T_total = T_TLB_miss + (Levels × T_table_access) + T_mem_access
(Example: 4-level paging = 20 + 100 + 100 + 100 + 100 + 100 = 520 ns)

Instruction	Meaning
LDR R1, var	Load address of variable var into register R1
LDR R1, [R2]	Load value from memory address in R2 into R1
STR R1, [R2]	Store value in R1 to memory address in R2
MOV R1, #const	Move constant value const into R1 (0-255 or cer
LDR R1, #const	Load any 32-bit constant into R1
ADD R1, R2, R3	R1 = R2 + R3
ADD R1, R2, #const	R1 = R2 + const
SUB R1, R2, R3	R1 = R2 - R3
SUB R1, R2, #const	R1 = R2 - const

Note how T3 misses the deadline. The deadline hits R1 at start of t=15 while active task runs from t=15 to t=16.

File descriptors

File descriptors	File table	Inode table
0	read	/home/foe/wikidb
1	write	...
2	read-write	/etc/passwd
3	...	...
4	...	...

CPU (Generates VA)
Virtual Address (PID + VPN + Offset)
Memory Management Unit(MMU)
Lookup using (PID, VPN)
Hash Function / Hash Table
Inverted Page Table (IPT)
Frame Process ID VPN Control Bits
0 102 15 Valid, etc.
1 105 27 Valid, etc.
2 102 18 Dirty, etc.
... ..
Match Found → Frame Number
Physical Address = (Frame number + Offset)
Physical Memory

Stack

Free Memory

Stack Pointer

Stack Frame for g()

Stack Frame for f()

Algorithm for TLB Fault Handler, given <Page #>:
1. [OS] Access full table of the process (e.g. in the PCB of the process). <Page#> is the index
2. [OS] Check whether valid bit is set, if not segmentation fault.
3. [OS] Load the relevant PTE into TLB.
4. [OS] Return from trap.

Multiples of Bytes
1000 kB = kilobyte
1024 KiB = 2¹⁰ bytes | MiB = 2²⁰ | GiB = 2³⁰
- Arrival time: point of time at which a process enters the ready queue.
- Waiting time: amount of time spent by a process waiting in the ready queue for getting the CPU.
- Response time: amount of time after which a process gets the CPU for the first time after entering the ready queue.
- execution time or running time: amount of time required by a process for executing on CPU.
- Completion time: point of time at which a process completes its execution on the CPU and takes exit from the system.
- Turn Around Time: total amount of time spent by a process in the system.
too small: may miss pages in current locality
too big: may contain pages from different locality
110101 < 1 = 1101010
W(t,1) = start from t-1 to t inclusive

Using LRU (13 faults)

1	2	3	4	6	2	5	1	4	3	6	1	3	5
Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N

Using Clock (13 faults)

1	2	3	4	6	2	5	1	4	3	6	1	3	5
Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N	Y	N

Processor Action

Processor Action	Logical Address	Physical Address
Fetch the 1 st instruction	<0, 0>	1 × 4 = 0 - 3
Load the 2 nd Data word	<1, 0>	5 × 4 = 1 - 3
Load the 3 rd Data word	<0, 2>	9 × 4 = 2 - 3
Load the 4 th Data word (This is intentionally outside of the range)	<-1, 1>	3 × 4 = 1 - 3

Page#

Page#	Frame#	Valid
0	5	T
1	3	T
2	10	T
3	-	F

Processor Action

Processor Action	Logical Address	Physical Address
Fetch the 1 st instruction	0	5 × 4 = 0 - 3
Load the 2 nd Data word	7	2 × 4 = 1 - 1
Load the 3 rd Data word	8	10 × 4 = 0 - 3
Load the 4 th Data word (This is intentionally outside of the range)	11	10 × 4 = 3 - 4

Process

write()

read()

Illustration: Process Table

Process Table

Process Control Block

Memory Space of a Process

1. [OS] Global/Local replacement, Replacement algorithm applicable here
2. [OS] Write out the page to be replaced if needed.
3. [OS] Locate the page in secondary swap pages.
4. [OS] Load the page into a physical frame.
5. [OS] Update page table entries.
6. [OS] Update TLB
7. [OS] Return from Trap